

CHAPTER I.

THE PRONOUN.

§ 32. *The Personal Pronoun. The Separate Pronoun.*

1. The personal pronoun (as well as the pronoun generally) *a* belongs to the oldest and simplest elements of the language (§ 30. 5). It should be considered *before* the verb, since it plays an important part in verbal inflexion (§§ 44, 47).

2. The independent principal forms of the personal pronoun serve *b* (like the Gk. *ἐγώ*, *σύ*, and the Lat. *ego*, *tu*, and their plurals) almost solely to emphasize the nominative-subject (see, however, § 135. 2). They are as follows:

Singular.	Plural.
1. Com. אֲנִי, in pause אֲנִי; } אֲנִי, in pause אֲנִי } I.	1. Com. אֲנַחְנוּ, in pause אֲנַחְנוּ } (נַחְנוּ, in pause נַחְנוּ), (אֲנוּ) } we.
2. { m. אַתָּה (אַתָּה), in pause אַתָּה or אַתָּה } f. אַתָּה (אַתָּה properly אַתָּה), } thou. in pause אַתָּה	2. { m. אַתֶּם f. אַתֶּנָּה (אַתֶּנָּה); אַתֶּן (אַתֶּן) } ye.
3. { m. הוּא he (if). f. הִיא she (if).	3. { m. הֵם (הֵם), הֵם } f. הֵנָּה after prefixes הֵן, הֵן } they.

The forms enclosed in parentheses are the less common. A table of these pronouns with their shortened forms (*pronominal suffixes*) is given in Paradigm A at the end of this Grammar.

REMARKS.

I. *First Person.*

1. The form אֲנִי is less frequent than אֲנִי¹. The former occurs in Phoenician, *c*

¹ On the prevalence of אֲנִי in the earlier Books compare the statistics collected by Giesebrecht in *ZAW.* 1881, p. 251 sqq., partly contested by Driver in the *Journal of Philology*, 1882, vol. xi. p. 222 sqq., (but cf. his *Introduction to the Old*

Moabite and Assyrian, but in no other of the kindred dialects¹; from the latter the suffixes are derived (§ 33). The *ð* most probably results from an obscuring of an original *a* (comp. Aram. אָנָה, Arab. 'ana). The pausal form אָנָה occurs not only with small disjunctive accents, but even with conjunctives; so always in אָנָה אֵל as *I live!* also Is. 49, 18 with *Munah*, Ps. 119, 25 with *Merkha* (which however has been altered from *Doh!*) and twice in Mal. 1, 6. In all these cases there is manifestly a disagreement between the vocalization already established and the special laws followed by the system of accentuation.

- d* 2. The formation of the plural in this and the other persons, exhibits a certain analogy with that of the noun, while at the same time (like the pronouns of other languages) it is characterized by many differences and peculiarities. The short form אָנָה (אָנָה) from which the suffix is derived occurs only in Jer. 42, 6 *K'ithbā*. The form אָנָה (comp. § 19. *h*) only in Ex. 16, 7. 8, Num. 32, 32, Lam. 3, 42; אָנָה in *pause*, Gen. 42, 11; in Arabic *adhamu* is the regular form. In the *Mišna* אָנָה (אָנָה) has altogether supplanted the longer forms.
- e* 3. The Pronoun of the 1st person only is, as a rule in languages, of the *common gender*, because the person who is present and speaking needs no further indication of gender, as does the 2nd person, who is addressed (in Greek, Latin, English, &c., this distinction is also lacking), and still more the 3rd person who is absent.

II. Second Person.

- f* 4. The forms of the 2nd person אָנָה, אָנָה, אָנָה, אָנָה, &c., are contracted from *anta*, &c. The kindred languages have retained the *n* before the א, e.g. Arab. 'anta, fem. 'anti, thou; pl. 'antum, fem. 'antunna, ye. In Syriac אָנָה, fem. אָנָה are written, but both are pronounced 'at. In Western Aramaic אָנָה is usual for both genders.
- g* אָנָה (without א) occurs five times, e.g. Ps. 6, 4, always as *K'ithbā*, with אָנָה as *Q'el*. In three places אָנָה appears as a masculine, Num. 11, 15. Deut. 5, 24. Ezek. 28, 14.
- h* The feminine form was originally אָנָה as in Syriac, Arabic and Ethiopic. This form is found seven times as *K'ithbā* (Jud. 17, 2. 1 Ki. 14, 2. 2 Ki. 4, 16. 23. 8, 1. Jer. 4, 30. Ezek. 36, 13) and appears also in the corresponding personal ending of verbs (see § 44. *f*) especially, and necessarily, before suffixes, as אָנָה אָנָה, § 59. 1, *c*; comp. also *l* as the ending of the 2nd fem. sing. of the Imperative and Imperfect. The final *l* was, however, gradually dropped in pronunciation, just as in Syriac (see above, letter *f*) it was eventually only written, not pronounced. The *l* therefore

Testament, p. 147, bottom, ed. 6, p. 155,) as well as by Delitzsch, *Genesis*, 1887, p. 28; fundamentally established by König in *Theologische Studien u. Kritik*, 1893, pp. 464 sqq. and 478, and in his *Einleitung in das A. T.*, p. 168, &c. In some of the latest Books (see the *Lexicon*) אָנָה is not found at all, and hardly at all in the Talmud.

¹ In Phoenician and Moabite (the inscription of *Mēša'*, line 1) it is written אָנָה, without the final א. In Punic it was pronounced *anec* (Plaut. *Poen.* 5, 1, 8) or *anech* (5, 2, 35). Comp. Schröder, *Phöniz. Sprache*, p. 143. In Assyrian the corresponding form is *anaku*, in ancient Egyptian *anek*, Coptic *anok*, *noh*.